

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump position sparks EU defiance

Leader adds tariffs to Greenland push, testing NATO allies

By Jamey Keaten, Emma Burrows and Will Weissert
Associated Press

DAVOS, Switzerland — President Donald Trump’s pledge to provoke a sweeping tariff fight with Europe to get his way in taking control of Greenland has left many of America’s closest allies warning of a rupture with Washington that would shatter the NATO alliance that had once seemed unshakable.

The European Union’s top official on Tuesday called Trump’s planned new tariffs over Greenland a “mistake” and questioned Trump’s trustworthiness. French

President Emmanuel Macron said the EU could retaliate against its long-standing ally by deploying one of its most powerful economic tools, known as a trade “bazooka.”

Trump prides himself on ratcheting up pressure to try and negotiate through a position of strength. He is slated to leave on Tuesday — the anniversary of his inauguration — for the World Economic Forum in Davos, Switzerland, a venue that could give him the chance to defuse tensions as quickly as he has sought to stir them up.

Trump made an unusual appearance in the White House briefing room to mark the one year he’d been in office. When asked how

far he’d be willing to go to acquire Greenland, Trump said only, “You’ll find out.”

Still, the president predicted there could be a deal with allies. “I think that we will work something out where NATO is going to be very happy, and where we’re going to be very happy,” he said, without providing specifics.

Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney, whose country is a founding NATO member, warned of global fissures beyond Greenland, suggesting it was an “illusion” and “fiction” that there remains a rules-based international order.

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President of the European Commission Ursula von der Leyen talks during the Annual Meeting of the World Economic Forum in Davos, Switzerland, on Tuesday. MARKUS SCHREIBER/AP



ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Frosty wintry walk

With a below-zero windchill, a pedestrian passes pockets of steam along Milwaukee Avenue in Chicago on Tuesday. Wednesday will likely bring the warmest temperatures of the week, with highs in the upper 20, weather officials say. Forecasts called for an “arctic cold front” to roll through the area on Thursday night, bringing bitter cold temperatures. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
High 29 Low 13	High 22 Low -9	High -3 Low -8	High 8 Low 3

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

Pritzker’s office inks new deal with lawyer

Attorney will continue to advise in talks with Bears on new stadium

By Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

Gov. JB Pritzker’s office signed a new \$25,000 contract late last month with an outside attorney to continue advising the administration in negotiations with the Chicago Bears through the end of June as the NFL franchise seeks to pressure Springfield to act this spring on a proposal that would aid plans for a new stadium in Arlington Heights.

The Pritzker administration’s top lawyer signed the agreement with Steve Argeris, a partner with New York-based law firm Weil, Gotshal & Manges, on Dec. 22, five days after the Tribune first reported Bears executives were widening the scope of their stadium-site search to include northwest Indiana. The team’s announcement in a letter to season ticket holders came a few weeks after Bears brass met with Pritzker and top aides in the governor’s Chicago office.

Under the agreement, the state will pay Argeris an hourly rate of \$1,455 to represent the governor’s office “in connection with evaluating potential stadium projects with one or more professional sports teams,” according to documents the Tribune obtained through an open records request. That’s a discount of more than 40% from the firm’s typical rate of \$2,575 per hour for its most experienced partners, records show.

Pritzker spokesperson Matt Hill said Tuesday that there was no connection between the timing of the agreement and the latest twist in the long-running stadium saga.

“Outside counsel is provided on an ongoing basis and does not correlate to specific developments or public announcements,” Hill said in a statement.

Indeed, the Tribune reported in May that the Pritzker administration had been working with Argeris — a New York- and Washington, D.C.-based sports, media and entertainment lawyer who formerly worked for the owners of the NFL’s Carolina Panthers — for a year and had paid him \$100,000 in taxpayer funds. The governor’s office began working with Argeris in June 2024, shortly after the Bears launched, with great fanfare, a push for public funding for a new domed stadium on Chicago’s lake-front.

Hill on Tuesday reiterated the Pritzker administration’s position that it needed outside expertise “to conduct due diligence and fully

Turn to Lawyer, Page 2

Johnson says he will not try to buy back parking meters

By Alice Yin, Jake Sheridan and A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

Mayor Brandon Johnson said Tuesday the city will not try to buy back Chicago’s parking meters after all, following days of speculation over whether he would attempt to find a way out of an infamous sale almost two decades ago.

Speaking to reporters at an unrelated event, the mayor confirmed he will forgo potentially purchasing the meters from the private company Chicago Parking Meters LLC.

Johnson said his team looked into making a bid for the city-wide system, which the company took control of for \$1.2 billion in a 75-year lease the City Council approved at Mayor Richard M. Daley’s behest in 2008, but determined the cost was “far too high.”

He said it would cost at least twice as much as that original lease price to buy the meters back, adding that the cash-strapped city would need to borrow to finance the purchase.

Chicagoans overwhelmingly



hate the deal — which has seen the private investors already recoup their investment and then some with decades of control ahead of them and parking rates continuing to rise — and City Hall

has been trying for years to figure out how to break it, to no avail.

“I want to put the rumors to bed. We are not pursuing

Turn to Meters, Page 7

Mayor Brandon Johnson arrives to talk about the city’s parking meters after days of speculation at the Chicago Cultural Center on Tuesday. EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A rags-to-riches story for Indiana

Indiana’s epic run from losers to 16-0 national champs rivals the 2016 Cubs’ journey. **Paul Sullivan in Chicago Sports**



LYNNE SLADKY/AP

Gender-affirming care scaled back

Lurie Children’s Hospital makes decision after a federal official calls for an investigation of the hospital. **Business**

Sweet and spicy on the North Side

Cleo’s, the American Southern cuisine eatery known for its fried fish and muffins, opens in Lakeview. **Food & Health**

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 21
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